Travel & Expense Reimbursement Policy

What the company pays for on business travel and how claims flow: approvals, channels, per-diem, caps and reimbursement timelines.

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EFFECTIVE	01 JAN 2026
FOR	ALL EMPLOYEES
CLASSIFICATION	INTERNAL / ALL EMPLOYEES

Emids reimburses reasonable business expenses incurred for approved work travel and client engagements. Two rules carry the document: travel needs pre-approval, and reimbursement needs receipts. Everything else explains whose approval, what caps and what timeline.

1. Pre-approval

- Domestic travel needs your manager's approval in the travel tool before booking.
- International travel needs business-unit head approval and an HR immigration pre-check (visa, tax, payroll impact).
- Emergency travel on verbal approval must be logged within 24 hours of speaking to your manager.

2. Booking and standards

Item	Standard
Air (domestic)	Economy, booked via the travel desk; fares beyond lowest +15% need justification
Rail	AC II tier / AC I on eligible grades
Hotel	Grade-wise city caps published by HR; hotel beyond cap = you pay the delta
Local transport	Cabs via empanelled vendor; self-drive fuel at published rates
Meals & per-diem	Domestic per-diem rate sheet; client-hosted meals are not claimed again

3. Claims and receipts

- Submit within 30 days of trip end in the claims tool; claims expire after 90 days.
- Original itemised receipts for everything above petty-cash thresholds; GST-compliant bills to company GSTIN where registered.
- One trip = one claim with all its bills; exceptions split at the approver's mention.

4. Advances

Cash advance up to 50% of estimated trip cost is available against an approved travel request. A settled advance must be fully accounted; unused advance recovered from the next claim or payroll, and repeat advances blocked until earlier ones reconcile.

5. What is not reimbursable

- Personal entertainment, minibar, movies, room service beyond meal caps — unless trip-period norms allow.
- Traffic / parking fines, lost receipts without a signed recon form (capped once per FY).
- Companion travel, lounge access unless eligible grade, and equipment we already issued you.

6. Timelines and payments

Verified claims are paid with the next payroll run or the fortnightly expense payout cycle, whichever you note in the claim; disputed claims route to the expense audit team with response within 5 working days. Continuous non-compliance (late, fictitious or padded claims) is a code-of-conduct breach, not merely a claim issue.

> If the situation is grey (client invite hosting, joint team dinner with partner companies), email the ask to your approver before spending — a one-line record beats a rejected ■8,000 claim.